

Contractor Scam Protection Guide V1 — Action Checklist

GENERATED May 11, 2026 | Print this page and keep it somewhere visible

- ☐ You hired someone to fix your home. They took your deposit and ghosted. Or they did half t...
- ☐ This guide exists because contractor fraud is not rare. It follows a predictable pattern o...
- ☐ This is not a guide about "finding a good contractor." It's about protecting yourself from...
- ☐ Contractor fraud works because homeowners rush. The leak is spreading. The roof is failing...
- ☐ Solicitation — They knock on doors after a storm, or they show up in your neighborhood wit...
- ☐ Large upfront payment — They ask for 50% or more before any work begins.
- ☐ Cash only — Refuses check or credit card. Wants payment in person, often to a third party.
- ☐ License and insurance gaps — When you ask, they stall, deflect, or show a document that lo...
- ☐ The vanish — Once they have the deposit, work either doesn't start or stops halfway. Getti...
- ☐ Understanding this pattern is step one. Now here's how to stop it.
- ☐ Before you sign anything — before you pay anything — run these five checks. Takes 15 minut...
- ☐ Every state has a Contractors State License Board (CSLB) or equivalent. Search "[your stat...

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library. Check off each item as you complete it.